Cum Sancta Mater

Pius IX · 1859-04-27 · English

ENCYCLICAL LETTER OF HIS HOLINESS POPE PIUS IX.

Zo our venerable Brethren the Patriarchs, Primates, Archbishops, Bishops, and other Ordinaries having grace and communion with the Apostolic See,

VENERABLE BRETHREN, HEALTH aND APOSTOLIC BENEDICTION :

"Ata time when, during these holy and festive days, Venerable Brethren, our Holy Mother, the Church, with one accord throughout the whole world is celebrating the unniversary solemnity of the Paschal Sacrament, and recalls to the memory of all her faithful children the most joyful words of that most sweet peace, which the only begotten Son of God, Christ Jesus Our Lord, after He had conquered death, and overthrown the tyranny of the devil, and was risen again, frequently and most lovingly announced to His Apostles and Disciples, at such a time behold! the sad ery of war is raised among Catho- lic Nations, and is sounding in the ears of all. We, therefore, since, although unworthy, we hold here upon earth the Office of Vicar of Him, who, when He was born of the Immaculate Virgin, announced by His angels peace to men of good will, and who, when He had risen from the dead, and was about to ascend up into Heaven to sit down at the right hand of His Father, left peace to His disciples. We cannot refrain, for the singular and entirely paternal love and solicitude by which we are urged especially towards Catholic people, from again a1.d again crying Pace, and from often ro eating unto all with the utmost vehemence of our soul the very words of Our Divine Redeemer, Peace be with you! Peace be with you! And with these words of peace we most lovingly exhort you, Venerable Brethren, who have been called to share our solicitude, to excite with all dili- gence and zeal the Faithful committed to your care, to pray unto the Most High God, that He may grant unto all his most Wished for peace. For this reason then, in our pas- toral office, we have not omitted to order public prayers throughout the whole of our Pontifical dominion, to be offered up to the most clement Father of Mercies, But follow.

ing the illustrious examples of our predecessors, we have determined tu fly also to: your prayers, and to the prayers of the whole Church. Wheretore, with these letters we earnestly require of you, Venerable Brethren, according to your singular devotion, to order public prayers in your diocess as soon as may be, by which the Faithful committed to your charge, after having invoked the most powerful patronage of the Immaculate and Most Holy Mother of God the Virgin Mary, may earnestly pray and beseech God, who is rich in mercy, that, through the merits of His only begutten Son Our Lord Jesus Christ, _dTe may turn away. his indignation from us, and remove wars far away, cxen.to the end of the carth—that he may enlighten the minds of all with Ilis divine grace, and inflame the hearts of all'with the love of Christian peace ; and that by Ilis omnipotent power He may bring to pass, that all men, being rooted and grounded in faith and love, may most diligently keep His commandments, and with humble and contrite heart implore pardon for their sins, that turning from evil and doing good, they may walk in the paths of jus- tice, and may possess and practise a continual mutual love among themselves; that so they may obtain a salutary peace with God, with themselves, and with all mankind. We do not doubt, Venerable Brethren, that in your manifest respect towards Our Person and the Apostolic See, you will be zealous in most diligently obeying these Our desires and prayers. But that the Faithful with more ardent zeal and more abundant fruit. may perse- vere in the prayers to be determined by you, we have thought it well to confer and be- stow upon them the treasures of heavenly rewards, the dispensation of which the Most lligh has entrusted: to Us. Wherefore, to the same Faithful, We grant an indulgence of three hundred days, in the accustomed form of the Church, to be gained as often as they devoutly take part in and recite the above-m ntioned prayers. Moreover, during the time of these prayers, We grant to the same Faithful a Plenary Indulgence, to be gained once only in the month, on that day, on which, having duly purified themselves by sacra- mental confession, and being refreshed with the most Holy Eucharist, they shall re- ligiously visit some Church, and there offer up devout prayers to God with the same in- tention. Lastly, there is nothing more pleasing to Us than totake this oceasion of. again testifying and confirming the singular good wi!l which we bear towards you all, Vener- wble Brethren. And of this Our most earnest good will towards you, let the pledge be Our Apostolic Benediction, which from our inmost heart we most lovingly bestow upon yourselves, Venerable Brethren, and upon all the Faithful, clergy and peo-

ple, committed to the charge of each one among you. ‘Given at Rome, at St. Peter’s, this 27th day of April, in the ycar of Our Lord 185). In the year of Our Pontificate the thirteenth.”

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